ENGLISH LAB · READING CORNER

Lantern Night

An old lantern. A lost tradition. A secret waiting to be told.



Base · A2

4 ESO · Seasons & Celebrations · LS2
Six chapters · one a week

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How to read this book

Read one chapter a week at home, with the Learning Path it goes with. Read it once for the story, then again more slowly.

The words in the box at the start help you. They are underlined in the story.

At the end of each chapter, circle one answer to each question. In class we talk about the chapter for ten minutes and see who guessed what happens next.

Llegeix un capítol cada setmana a casa, amb el Learning Path que li toca. Llegeix-lo una vegada per entendre la història i una altra més a poc a poc.

Les paraules del requadre de l'inici t'ajuden: estan subratllades a la història.

Al final de cada capítol, encercla una resposta a cada pregunta. A classe en parlem deu minuts i mirem qui ha endevinat què passa després.

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CHAPTER 1

The lantern in the attic

Read it with Learning Path 0

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

attic = *golfes*
bridge = *pont*
lantern = *fanalet*
frightened = *espantada*

Núria Puig arrived in Ashby on a cold Saturday at the end of October. She was fifteen and came from Catalonia. Her exchange partner Josh Green met her at the station. “Welcome to northern England,” he said. “Do you like rain?”

“A little,” Núria answered. “But I like the sun too.”

She stayed with Josh’s mum Helen, his little sister Amy and their gran. During the week Núria got up at seven and went to school with Josh.

The family had dinner at six, much earlier than her family in Catalonia.

“Six o’clock?” Núria said.

“At home we eat at nine!”

On 31 October they celebrated Halloween. Amy dressed up as a witch and Josh decorated a pumpkin. Núria explained the Castanyada, which people celebrate in Catalonia. “We eat chestnuts, sweet potatoes and little cakes called panellets.”

“Let’s make some tomorrow!” Helen said. “There are old trays in the attic.”

After dinner Josh and Núria went upstairs.

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The attic was cold and full of boxes. There were old toys and Christmas decorations. Núria found a red and gold lantern near the window. It looked very old. There was a handwritten message on it: "M. — Lantern Night, at the old bridge. I'll wait for you. T."

"Who is T?" she asked.

"No idea," Josh replied. "Maybe Gran knows."

They showed Gran the lantern. She was usually quiet but friendly, and she always had tea at four. This time she looked frightened.

She read the message twice and stood up. "Please put that back in the attic," she said. She left the room without another word.

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

What makes Gran upset?

Què preocupa la Gran?

(A) An old lantern with a message

(B) A pumpkin costume

(C) Núria's homework

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What do Josh and Núria find at the library?

Què troben en Josh i la Núria a la biblioteca?

(A) An old phone

(B) A poster for Lantern Night in 1974

(C) A letter from Canada dated today

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CHAPTER 2

A poster from 1974

Read it with Learning Path 1

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

community centre = *centre cívic*
storm = *tempesta*
lantern = *fanalet*
damaged = *malmès*

Gran didn't come down for breakfast the next morning. Josh and Núria were worried. They wanted to understand why the lantern made her afraid.

"Let's go to the library," Josh said. "Mrs Okafor knows everything about Ashby."

The library was in the community centre, near the town square. Mrs Okafor looked at the red and gold lantern and smiled. "Lantern Night! I remember reading about that. Come with me." She showed them a large poster: "ASHBY LANTERN NIGHT — SATURDAY 16 NOVEMBER 1974. PARADE FROM THE TOWN SQUARE TO THE OLD BRIDGE. MUSIC AND HOT FOOD. BRING YOUR LANTERN!"

Mrs Okafor explained that Lantern Night used to be a local autumn festival. Families used to make paper lanterns and walk to the bridge together. They lit candles and made a wish.

"Many celebrations have lights," Núria said. "People light diyas at Diwali. In Catalonia we celebrate the Castanyada with chestnuts and panellets. It's different, but families eat together too."

"Exactly," Mrs Okafor replied. "Traditions can be different and still have some things that are the same."

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Mrs Okafor also showed them a photograph of children with lanterns made at home. “Families used to sing and eat together,” she said.

It looked like a happy night.

“Why did Lantern Night stop?” Josh asked.

Mrs Okafor took out an old newspaper. “In 1974 there was a terrible storm on the day of the festival. The old bridge was damaged and the festival was cancelled. Nobody organised it again. The young man in charge moved away.”

“Who was he?” Núria asked. “Tom Barker. He went to Canada.” Núria looked at the message on the lantern: “I’ll wait for you. T.”

“Josh,” she said quietly, “I think T means Tom.”

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

What did people do at Lantern Night?

Què feia la gent a Lantern Night?

- (A) They held a parade to the old bridge
- (B) They went on a school trip to London
- (C) They played a football match

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

Who is M on the lantern?

Qui és M al fanalet?

- (A) Mrs Okafor
- (B) Amy
- (C) Gran, whose name was Margaret Hall

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CHAPTER 3

Who is M?

Read it with Learning Paths 2 and 3

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

forum = *fòrum*
caption = *peu de foto*
evidence = *proves*
reliable = *fiable*

That evening Josh and Núria searched online for Tom Barker and Lantern Night. They wanted to know who M was.

"Let's check our sources," Núria said. "Who wrote the information? When? Is it reliable?"

First, they found a forum. A user said that two families had a big argument in 1974, but there was no name, date or evidence.

"That isn't a fact," Josh said. "It's just someone's opinion."

Next, they found a photo of people with lanterns.

It looked real, but there was no date and no credit.

"We don't know who took it," Núria said.

Finally, they opened an old article in the Ashby Herald. It had the date, 17 November 1974, and the journalist's name. It explained that a strong storm broke part of the old bridge and cancelled the parade. Tom Barker, the man in charge, planned to leave for Canada. There was a photo too. A young woman in the picture held a red and gold lantern.

The caption said: "Margaret Hall, 19, helps Tom Barker organise Lantern Night." Josh looked at the screen. "Margaret Hall! That's Gran! She was Hall before she married Grandad."

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"Then M is Margaret," Núria said. "Tom wanted to meet her at the bridge. But the storm stopped them."

They sat quietly for a moment. Núria wrote the date, author and facts in her notebook. Then she had an idea. "What if we bring Lantern Night back? We can invite the school, make lanterns and organise a parade."

"This year?" Josh asked.

"Why not? We can make a plan."

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

Which source gives the most reliable evidence?

Quina font ofereix les proves més fiables?

- (A) An anonymous forum
- (B) A dated newspaper article with a journalist's name
- (C) A photo without a date

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What permission will the group need?

Quin permís necessitarà el grup?

- (A) Permission to use the old bridge
- (B) Permission to travel to Canada
- (C) Permission to change schools

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CHAPTER 4

Plan the day

Read it with Learning Path 4

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

timetable = *horari*
council = *ajuntament*
workshop = *taller*
permission = *permís*

On Monday Josh and Núria told their friends Priya and Callum about Lantern Night. "We're going to bring it back on Saturday 12 December," Núria said. "We need help."

"I'll make the posters," Callum said.

"And I'll make a timetable," Priya said. "If we don't organise the day, it'll be a big problem."

At lunch they made a list. They needed to book the school hall, invite families, find a band and ask the council for permission to use the old bridge.

"My uncle plays in a band," Priya said. "I'm going to ask him tonight."

"I'm meeting Mr Davies, the head teacher, on Wednesday," Josh said.

"It will rain," Callum said. "It's December."

"People can bring umbrellas," Núria answered.

The friends decided to make the event free. Children and their parents could join the workshop, and local people could bring food for everybody. Priya checked the list twice. She wanted everyone to know their job.

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Mr Davies liked the idea and offered the school hall for a free workshop. The group agreed on a timetable: four o'clock, lantern workshop; half past five, food in the square; six o'clock, parade; seven o'clock, music at the bridge.

"But the council looks after the bridge," Josh said. "We can't use it without permission."

"I'll write a formal email," Núria said. "We practised that in class."

Callum finished a beautiful poster with a dark sky and hundreds of lanterns.

That evening Josh printed it and put it on the kitchen table. When Gran came in for dinner, she stopped beside the poster. She read the words "ASHBY LANTERN NIGHT IS BACK!" and looked at Josh.

"Who told you about Tom?" she asked.

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

What must they ask the council?

Què han de demanar a l'ajuntament?

(A) Money for fireworks

(B) A new bus

(C) Permission to use the bridge

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What will Gran do after seeing the poster?

Què farà la Gran després de veure el cartell?

(A) Tell the teenagers her story

(B) Leave Ashby forever

(C) Stop the school project immediately

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CHAPTER 5

Gran's story

Read it with Learning Path 5

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

upset = *disgustar*
retired = *jubilat*
lost contact = *van perdre el contacte*
attached = *va adjuntar*

When Gran asked about Tom, nobody spoke for a moment. Then Núria explained about the lantern and the newspaper article. "We're sorry," she said. "We didn't want to upset you."

Gran sat down. "Tom lived next door when I was young. We used to walk to school together, and we used to organise Lantern Night every year. We became more than friends."

In 1974 Tom got a job in Canada. He asked Margaret to go with him, but she didn't know what to decide.

He wrote a message on her lantern and said he would wait for her at the old bridge on Lantern Night.

"But the storm was terrible," Gran continued. "My father didn't let me go out. When I arrived, the bridge was closed. Tom left the next week. We wrote some letters, and then we lost contact."

"Were you sad?" Josh asked.

"I missed him," Gran said.

"But later I met your grandad, and we had a happy life. I never forgot the festival." That evening Núria wrote to the town council. She used a formal email: "Dear Councillor Hughes, I am writing to propose a celebration on Saturday 12 December. We would like to organise a lantern workshop and a parade. Could we use the old bridge

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from 6 to 8 p.m.? I look forward to hearing from you. Kind regards, Núria Puig." She checked the date and pressed send. At the same time, Josh found a retired teacher called Tom Barker in Toronto.

His profile showed a red and gold lantern. Josh attached the festival poster and wrote: "Hello. I think you knew my gran, Margaret Hall…"

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

Why did Margaret miss Tom at the bridge?

Per què la Margaret no es va trobar amb en Tom al pont?

- (A) She forgot the date
- (B) The storm and her father kept her home, and the bridge closed
- (C) Tom went to a different town

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What will Tom do after Josh contacts him?

Què farà en Tom després del missatge d'en Josh?

- (A) Delete the message
- (B) Send a photo of Australia
- (C) Come to Lantern Night

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CHAPTER 6

Lantern Night

Read it with the final product

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

permission = *permís*
repaired = *reparat*
clapped = *van aplaudir*
published = *va publicar*

Two answers arrived the next week. The town council gave permission to use the old bridge; it was repaired years ago. Tom Barker also answered Josh's message, but Josh kept his reply a surprise. On Saturday 12 December, the morning was cold and foggy. Callum was worried about the weather. "It will rain," he said.

"Look at the sky," Núria replied. "I think it'll be fine."

By the afternoon the fog disappeared.

At four o'clock more than two hundred people arrived at the school hall. Families made lanterns, the band played and food tables gave people hot soup. Núria brought panellets for everybody to try. Volunteers checked the lights and helped families find the right way. The friends were tired but proud. Their school plan became a real town celebration, and everyone smiled. At six, the parade left the town square.

Hundreds of colourful lanterns lit the dark streets.

Gran walked at the front, carrying her old red and gold lantern. Josh stayed beside her. When they got to the old bridge, an older man waited on the other side. He held a lantern that looked like Gran's. "Hello, Margaret," the man said. "I'm sorry I'm late."

Gran stopped.

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"Tom? Only fifty-two years late!" Then they laughed.

People around them clapped, but Josh and Núria gave them space to talk. The next day the Ashby Herald published a photo of the festival.

It said that Lantern Night would return next December, organised by young people and local families.

"Will you come back next year?" Josh asked Núria.

"Of course. I'll bring more panellets," she said.

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

Who appears at the old bridge?

Qui apareix al pont vell?

- (A) Tom Barker with a lantern
- (B) A television presenter
- (C) The mayor in a witch costume

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What does the town plan to do next December?

Què preveu fer el poble el desembre següent?

- (A) Close the bridge again
- (B) Celebrate Lantern Night again
- (C) Cancel all winter festivals

✦ ✦ ✦

The end

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